Think like your audience

Understand the decisions, concerns and language of the people in the room.

Why this step matters

Understand what people think, feel and value before deciding what they need. Listening and observing help you separate their real concerns from your assumptions.

For example Before explaining automation, ask an operations leader which handoffs cause the most frustration. Their answer may change the story you planned to tell.

1A · Management perspective map

Consider the business, operations, technology and value perspectives.

Management lens	What they care about	What they may challenge
Business / executive leader		
Operations leader		
Technology / digital leader		
Finance / value owner		

Stage output

Complete: “Management needs to understand...”

The audience’s real need

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Listen before explaining

Use these prompts to separate your assumptions from what the audience actually needs.

They already know...

They probably do not care about...

They may be skeptical about...

They need evidence of...

After the presentation, I want them to...

Working agreement

Work through lessons 1–5 in order. Use plain language and real internal examples. Keep confidential details generic. Explore several explanations. Test comprehension before visual polish. Complete and test the storyboard before opening PowerPoint or prompting a slide-generation tool.

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Decide what the story must achieve

Turn a broad presentation topic into a precise problem and a desired decision.

Why this step matters

Bring your observations together and name the problem clearly. A useful problem statement connects the current situation with the understanding or decision you want to create.

For example “Explain automation” is a topic. “Help leaders decide which manual process to improve first” gives your story a purpose.

2A · Ask why five times

Start with: “We need to explain how automation is being used.” Ask why until you reach the real decision, understanding or behaviour the story should create.

Why 1

Why 2

Why 3

Why 4

Why 5

2B · Define the challenge

Complete both parts of the same statement.

Management needs to understand...

...so that they can decide, support or prioritise...

How might we explain this without turning it into a technology lecture?

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Create five different explanations

Widen your options before choosing a storyline.

Why this step matters

Explore different possibilities before judging them. Generating several ideas gives you options to compare and combine instead of committing to the first familiar answer.

For example Try telling the same story through an employee's day, a before-and-after process and a business outcome. Then compare what each makes clear.

3A · Five ways to tell the story

Explain the same business capability from each angle. Write one sentence per approach; do not design slides yet.

Narrative angle	Your one-line story
Technology evolution	
Work complexity	
Employee / user journey	
Business capability journey	
One end-to-end process example	

Prompts when you get stuck

Evolution: rules-based automation intelligent automation agentic automation.Complexity: predictable work unstructured information decisions exceptions.Journey: discover understand decide execute improve.Before / after: manual augmented coordinated work.

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Break the default presentation

Use reversal to expose weak habits, then select the clearest framing.

3B · Worst possible presentation

Be specific and slightly absurd. Reverse every bad idea into a useful rule. Example: “Start with 20 product names” becomes “Start with the business problem.”

Worst possible idea	Reverse it into a good rule
Idea 1	
Idea 2	
Idea 3	

3C · Compare your story options

Score each quality from 1 (weak) to 5 (strong). Total the three scores; use judgement to choose one primary storyline and one backup.

Option	Simple	Business relevant	Memorable	Total
A				
B				
C				
D				
E				

Primary storyline and why

Backup storyline

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Build a memorable mental model

Make the story tangible with a small set of connected business capabilities.

Why this step matters

Make your idea tangible with something quick and inexpensive, such as a sketch or storyboard. A prototype helps people react to the idea while it is still easy to change.

For example Write one headline and one example on each of eight slide cards. Rearrange the cards to try a different story before designing the slides.

4A · Map capabilities into plain language

Discover automate understand decide orchestrate improve is a starting point. Keep only what your story needs.

Capability	Plain-language explanation	Real example
Discover		
Automate		
Understand		
Decide		
Orchestrate		
Improve		

Your one-sentence mental model

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Explain the difference clearly

Give each capability one sentence that a non-technical colleague can repeat.

Robotic process automation (RPA)

Predictable, rules-based work executed consistently.

Process mining

Understanding how a process actually runs, where it deviates and where it can improve.

AI / intelligent understanding

Interpreting documents, text and other unstructured information.

Agents

Reasoning towards a goal and choosing actions within defined boundaries.

Orchestration

Coordinating people, robots, workflows, agents and systems.

RPA is...

Process mining is...

Intelligent understanding is...

An agent is...

Clarity check

Could an executive explain how these capabilities differ after hearing your story once?

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Build the storyboard · slides 1–4

Make one claim per slide, supported by evidence and a clear point.

One box per slide. No animation, formatting or product screenshots yet. Start with this eight-slide outline and combine slides if six or seven tell the story better.

Slide 1 · Why this matters

What business or work problem opens the story?

Slide 1 headline

Slide 1 evidence / visual / example

Slide 1 key point

Slide 2 · Rules-based automation

What predictable work are we automating?

Slide 2 headline

Slide 2 evidence / visual / example

Slide 2 key point

Slide 3 · Process discovery

How do we discover how the process really works?

Slide 3 headline

Slide 3 evidence / visual / example

Slide 3 key point

Slide 4 · Intelligent understanding

Where do documents, text or interpretation enter?

Slide 4 headline

Slide 4 evidence / visual / example

Slide 4 key point

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Internal

Build the storyboard · slides 5–8

Make one claim per slide, supported by evidence and a clear point.

One box per slide. No animation, formatting or product screenshots yet. Start with this eight-slide outline and combine slides if six or seven tell the story better.

Slide 5 · Agents

Where is reasoning useful beyond fixed rules?

Slide 5 headline

Slide 5 evidence / visual / example

Slide 5 key point

Slide 6 · The system view

How do these capabilities connect?

Slide 6 headline

Slide 6 evidence / visual / example

Slide 6 key point

Slide 7 · Real use case

Which real end-to-end internal example makes this concrete?

Slide 7 headline

Slide 7 evidence / visual / example

Slide 7 key point

Slide 8 · Takeaway / ask

What should management remember, support or decide?

Slide 8 headline

Slide 8 evidence / visual / example

Slide 8 key point

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Follow one process from discovery to action

Use a real internal example. Describe confidential details generically.

Use case / process name

Step	Before	With automation	Capability used
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			

Connect only the capabilities you need

Not every process needs every capability. Explain how people and systems work together.

What discovers, executes, interprets, decides, approves, coordinates and monitors?

Business outcome	What changes	How we would show it
Time / speed		
Cost / effort		
Quality / consistency		
Risk / compliance		
Employee / customer experience		

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Let management challenge the story

Test the logic and language before polishing the deck.

Why this step matters

Find out whether your idea works for the people who need it. Test assumptions, listen to feedback and revise the explanation—or revisit the problem when needed.

For example Ask a colleague to repeat your story back. If they confuse an agent with rules-based automation, revise the explanation and try again.

5A · Five-minute management simulation

Presenter: deliver the storyboard in five minutes. Reviewer: interrupt naturally and note where the explanation becomes vague, technical or unsupported.

[ ] Why do we need an agent if rules-based automation already works?
[ ] Why process mining—do we not already know our processes?
[ ] Where are we using this today?
[ ] What is proven and what is experimental?
[ ] What business value do we get?
[ ] What still requires a human?
[ ] What risks and controls matter?
[ ] Why is this platform or approach suitable?
[ ] What should management do after this presentation?

5B · One-line response bank

Write a clear answer to each challenge.

Management question	One-sentence answer
RPA versus agent?	
Why process mining?	
What is intelligent automation?	
Where is the human?	
What is the value?	
What is the ask?	

What needs revision after the simulation?

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Make the story work without slides

Deliver a 30-second explanation, then listen to someone teach it back.

5C · Elevator explanation

Imagine meeting a senior executive outside the meeting room. Explain the business problem, connected capabilities, one example and the ask without jargon.

Your 30-second explanation

5D · Teach-back test

Ask a reviewer to explain the story back to you. Let them finish before correcting anything.

Can they explain...	Yes / no	What was lost or misunderstood?
What RPA does		
What process mining does		
What agents add		
How the capabilities connect		
One real business example		
Why management should care		

[ ] One clear management objective
[ ] The story starts with a business problem
[ ] Each capability can be explained in one sentence
[ ] One memorable model connects the capabilities
[ ] At least one real end-to-end use case
[ ] A clear takeaway or ask
[ ] The story survived skeptical questions
[ ] The 30-second explanation works without slides

Now build or prompt the presentation

Now open PowerPoint or prompt a slide-generation tool. Use your tested storyboard to guide it, then check that the slides preserve your evidence, meaning and ask.

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